Svayam prakasha (self-luminosity; reflexivity of consciousness): the view that when a subject cognises an object or fact simultaneously and in virtue of the same act he is aware of himself cognising that entity. For Buddhists such as ***Vasubandhu***, ***Dignaga*** and ***Dharmakirti*** who deny that there is an enduring self that is the permanent background to experiences that it 'possesses', it is individual mental states that are characterised by self-awareness. For *Vedantins*, the permanent soul is self-aware.

More generally, some (***Vijnanavada*** Buddhism, ***Advaita-Vedanta***, ***Ramanuja***, ***Samkhya*** and ***Trika*** Shaivism) appeal to the self-luminosity of consciousness as a way of expressing its foundational nature. Everything material needs the light of consciousness for its manifestation and determination as an existent entity. Consciousness requires nothing outside itself.

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Lipner 1986; Matilal 1986; Mohanty 1992

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Tadatmya see ***Svabhava-pratibandha***

Tantra: in parallel with Vedic orthodoxy, there is another broad family of religious traditions basing themselves on texts called *Tantras*, *Agamas* and *Samhitas*. Some of these cults are compatible with the Vedic tradition; others reject it. Their scriptures usually have four parts: metaphysical teachings (*vidya-pada*), ritual instructions (*kriya-pada*), ethical behaviour (*carya-pada*) and individual spiritual practice (*yoga-pada*). They describe the constitution of the cosmos, the nature of God, the soul in its original